JAMES RICHARDSON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Forward Deployed Engineer with 1 year of hands-on experience supporting field operations and troubleshooting infrastructure issues in challenging environments. I have a strong foundation in Linux system administration and networking, gained through deployment support roles where I learned to problem-solve under pressure. I'm keen to deepen my technical expertise while continuing to work closely with teams in the field to understand real-world operational needs.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Forward Deployed Engineer

TacticalOps Solutions

tacticalops.io

London, United Kingdom

June 2023 - Present

Provided on-site technical support to field teams across 8 different deployment locations, diagnosing and resolving hardware and software issues within 24-hour windows.

Managed Linux server configurations and performed system hardening tasks to meet security compliance requirements for sensitive operations.

Coordinated with remote engineering teams to escalate complex issues and documented solutions in a centralized knowledge base used by 15+ engineers.

Participated in pre-deployment testing of applications and infrastructure components, identifying 12 critical bugs before field rollout.

Junior Systems Administrator

NetSecure UK Ltd

netsecure.co.uk

Reading, United Kingdom

February 2023 - May 2023

Assisted in maintaining on-premises Linux and Windows servers supporting 200+ internal users across three office locations.

Performed regular system patching, backups, and monitoring alert response during business hours with average resolution time of 90 minutes.

Configured and deployed Nagios monitoring for 40+ servers, reducing mean time to detection for critical issues from 45 minutes to 8 minutes.

Shadowed senior administrators on network infrastructure projects and documented processes to create training materials for junior staff.

IT Support Technician

Keble College, University of Oxford

oxford.ac.uk

Oxford, United Kingdom

September 2022 - January 2023

Provided first-line IT support to 400+ college members including students, academics, and staff via ticketing system and phone helpdesk.

Resolved hardware issues including printer configuration, device imaging, and network connectivity problems with 95% first-contact resolution rate.

Maintained and updated hardware inventory database across college accommodation and teaching facilities.

Assisted in planning and executing system upgrades for college-wide email migration affecting 350+ users.

EDUCATION

BSc (Hons) Computer Science

University of Birmingham

Birmingham, United Kingdom

Graduated: June 2022

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Operating Systems: Linux (Ubuntu, CentOS), Windows Server 2019/2022

Networking: TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, VPN configuration, firewall management

System Administration: Active Directory, user account management, group policies, system hardening

Monitoring and Logging: Nagios, rsyslog, basic ELK stack implementation

Scripting: Bash, Python (basic)

Databases: MySQL (basic)

Tools and Platforms: Git, Docker (basic), Apache, Nginx

Cloud Platforms: AWS basics (EC2, S3)

Other: SSH, SSL/TLS certificates, vulnerability scanning with OpenVAS

PUBLIC REPOSITORIES

github.com/jrichardson92/linux-hardening-scripts - Collection of Bash scripts for automated Linux system hardening and security configuration

github.com/jrichardson92/nagios-config-templates - Reusable Nagios monitoring templates for common server types and services

github.com/jrichardson92/deployment-troubleshooting-guide - Documentation and diagnostic tools for field troubleshooting scenarios

CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA A+ (In Progress)